LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Commerce (Accountancy, Business Studies, Economics): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build Maths, English and money sense; try Maths Olympiad (IOQM from Class 8)	Olympiad ladder, NMMS scholarship (Class 8)
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Take Standard Maths if unsure; understand commerce streams	Keeps Economics Hons, IPM, Actuarial and Statistics open
Stream choice	After Class 10	Commerce with Maths, or without Maths (Accountancy, Business Studies, Economics + one of Maths / Informatics / English / Statistics)	Course eligibility differs: some need Maths in Class 12
Professional track	Class 11-12 onward	Choose CA, CS, CMA, or a degree track (BCom, BBA, BA Economics)	Foundation exams can start after Class 12
Degree / exams	After Class 12	BCom / BBA / IPM / BA LLB / Actuarial / ACCA with a professional course alongside	Professional licence or management career
Postgraduate	3-5 years later	MBA, MCom, MA Economics, LLM, CFA, specialisations	Senior finance, management, policy, research roles
Career	-	Finance, accounting, management, law, economics, entrepreneurship	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-8: Foundation

- Decision: strengthen Maths and English; join Olympiads for problem-solving. There is no single formal Commerce olympiad, so Maths and English Olympiads are the useful early signals.†
- Unlocks: NMMS scholarship test in Class 8; IOQM (Maths Olympiad) from Class 8.

Class 9-10: Pre-board

- Decision: in CBSE, choose Standard Maths for Class 10 if there is any chance of Economics Hons, IPM, Actuarial Science, Statistics or CA with a Maths-heavy profile.†
- Explore: personal finance, accounts basics, economics concepts from the Class 9-10 Social Science syllabus.

After Class 10: Stream choice

- Choose Commerce. Core subjects: Accountancy, Business Studies, Economics, English. Add one: Mathematics, Informatics Practices / Computer Science, Statistics or Physical Education.
- Take Mathematics if you want: BA / BSc Economics (Hons), IPM (IIM Indore / Rohtak), Actuarial Science, B.Stat, B.Com (Hons) at some universities, or a data-driven finance career.
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Board marks matter: BCom admission in Karnataka is mostly merit-based on 2nd PUC / Class 12 marks. CA Foundation registration must be done at least four months before the exam.†

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- Apply in parallel: CUET-UG (central universities), IPMAT, CLAT, SET / NPAT and college tests; register for CA / CS / CMA Foundation or entrance as per calendar.

After Class 12: Degree and professional courses

- Professional: CA, CS, CMA (can be pursued alongside BCom).
- Degrees: BCom (General / Hons / Professional), BBA / BMS, BA / BSc Economics, BA LLB / BBA LLB, BSc Statistics / Actuarial Science, 5-year IPM.
- International certifications: ACCA, CFA.

3. Olympiads and early exams (Class 6-10 and beyond)

Exam	Conducted by	Classes	Levels	Timing (2026-27 cycle)
IOQM (Maths)	HBCSE with MTAI	8-12 (born 1 Aug 2007 to 31 Jul 2014)	IOQM, then RMO, then INMO	IOQM held 6 Sep 2026; RMO / INMO later†
International Mathematics Olympiad (IMO) / English Olympiad (IEO)	Science Olympiad Foundation (SOF)	1-12	Level 1 (school) then Level 2†	Level 1 Oct-Dec, Level 2 Jan-Mar†
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8 (govt, aided and local body schools)	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb (last held 1 Feb 2026)
NTSE	NCERT; Karnataka Stage 1 via DSERT	10 (covers Social Science too)	Stage 1 state, Stage 2 national	No sign of discontinuation; 2026-27 notification expected Aug-Oct†
INSPIRE-MANAK	DST with NIF	6-12	School nominates up to 5 ideas	Last nominations closed 15 Sep 2025; check inspireawards-dst.gov.in†

Tip for parents: Commerce has fewer early exams than Science, so school Maths, English, public speaking, and business-related projects (school enterprise or finance clubs) build the profile.

4. Professional courses and entrance exams

CA (Chartered Accountancy) - ICAI: Foundation level	
Conducting body	Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI); icai.org
Stages	Foundation -> Intermediate -> Articleship (practical training) -> Final
Eligibility	Class 12 pass from a recognised board; can register while in Class 12 if finished before the exam. Reported: Class 10 passers can register provisionally. Register at least four months before the exam†
Frequency	Foundation reported thrice a year (January, May/June, September); September 2026 papers were scheduled for 2, 5, 7 and 9 September (offline)†
Pattern	4 papers of 100 marks (400): Paper 1 Accounting and Paper 2 Business Laws (subjective); Paper 3 Business Mathematics, Logical Reasoning and Statistics and Paper 4 Business Economics (objective MCQs, 0.25 negative marking)
Passing	At least 40% in each paper and 50% aggregate†
Later stages	Intermediate exams reported three times a year (Jan, May, Sep); articleship reported as 3 years, with a shorter two-year model under the new scheme from Sep 2026; Final frequency reported as twice or thrice a year. All conflict across sources†

CS (Company Secretary) - ICSI: CSEET	
Conducting body	Institute of Company Secretaries of India (ICSI); icsi.edu
Eligibility	Indian nationals who have passed Class 12 (appearing candidates can also apply)†

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Frequency	Previously four sessions a year (Jan, May, Jul, Nov); ICSI announced three sessions a year (February, June, October) from the June 2026 session. June 2026 session ran 1-4 June. October 2026 dates not confirmed†
Pattern	Revised pattern reported as four 100-mark papers (Business Communication; Fundamentals of Accounting; Economic and Business Environment; Business Laws and Management), centre-based pen-and-paper over four days. Older pattern was 200 marks. Sources conflict†
Later stages	Executive -> Professional programmes with practical training

CMA (Cost and Management Accountant) - ICMAI: Foundation	
Conducting body	Institute of Cost Accountants of India (ICMAI); eicmai.in
Eligibility	Class 12 pass (or appearing, with provisional registration)†
Frequency	Twice a year (June and December). June 2026 exam on 14 June; December 2026 tentatively mid-December, with the no-late-fee form deadline reported as 14 Oct 2026†
Pattern	4 papers, MCQ-based, OMR; reported as pass with 40% in each paper and 50% aggregate†
Fee	About 6,000 (reported)†
Later stages	Foundation -> Intermediate -> Final with practical training

IPMAT (Integrated Programme in Management Aptitude Test)	
Conducting body	IIM Indore (also IIM Rohtak with its own test); iimidr.ac.in and iimrohtak.ac.in
Used for	5-year integrated programme in management (BBA + MBA) at IIM Indore and IIM Rohtak
Eligibility	Indore: born on or after 1 Aug 2006 (5-year relaxation SC/ST/PwD); Class 12 passed or appearing in 2024-2026; minimum marks reported as none by one source and 60% by another. Rohtak: born on or after 30 Jun 2005; 60% in Class 10 and 12 (55% reserved)†
Frequency / date	Once a year; 2026: Indore on 4 May, Rohtak on 10 May
Pattern (Indore)	Computer-based, 2 hours: Quantitative Ability MCQ, Quantitative Ability short answer, Verbal Ability MCQ; +4 / -1 for MCQs. Rohtak pattern not confirmed†

CUET-UG (for BCom and other degrees at central and other universities)	
Conducting body	NTA, cuet.nta.nic.in
Used for	BCom, BCom (Hons), BA Economics and BBA seats at Delhi University, BHU, Allahabad University and others
Subjects	Typically a language, plus three domain subjects (Accountancy / Book Keeping, Business Studies, Economics, Mathematics / Applied Mathematics) or one domain subject + General Aptitude Test; combinations vary by university; BCom (Hons) often asks for Maths or Accountancy†
Pattern / marking	Computer-based; 50 MCQs per domain subject, 60 minutes, +5 / -1 (see Science documents)
Frequency / month	Once a year; May-June†

CLAT (Common Law Admission Test) - for BA LLB / BBA LLB	
Conducting body	Consortium of National Law Universities; consortiumofnlus.ac.in
Eligibility	Class 12 or equivalent (appearing candidates allowed); about 45% for General (40% SC/ST)†
Frequency / date	Once a year; CLAT 2027 expected 6 December 2026, application deadline reported as 31 October 2026 (official notification not seen)†

Pattern	120 MCQs, 2 hours, offline: English, Current Affairs / GK, Legal Reasoning, Logical Reasoning, Quantitative Techniques; +1 / -0.25. A committee may revise the pattern†

ACET (Actuarial Common Entrance Test) - Institute of Actuaries of India	
Conducting body	Institute and Faculty of Actuaries India / Institute of Actuaries of India (IAI); actuariesindia.org
Eligibility	Class 12 pass or appearing; sources conflict on whether English or Mathematics is required†
Frequency / date	Held twice a year in some years; 2026 exam on 13 June (results 23 June)†
Pattern	Online, 3 hours, 70 MCQs on Mathematics, Statistics, Data Interpretation, English and Logical Reasoning. Score valid for three years

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
BCom admission in Karnataka (BCU and other universities)	BCom General / Hons	Mostly merit-based on 2nd PUC / Class 12 marks with no entrance exam; Christ and some deemed universities run their own admission process; some colleges ask 50%†
SET, NPAT, Christ University tests and college-specific tests	BBA / BMS at Symbiosis, NMIMS, Christ and similar	SET reported for May and NPAT for Mar-May 2026; dates and registration windows change every year†
ACCA	Global accountancy qualification	Class 12 students may enter directly if they meet marks rules (reported as English plus Maths or Accounts; marks thresholds conflict); otherwise ACCA Foundations route†
CFA (CFA Institute)	Investment and finance credential	Exam windows and eligibility not confirmed at the time of compilation; usually pursued during or after degree†
Banking, insurance and government jobs	After graduation	IBPS / SBI / RBI / SSC / UPSC exams; not covered at the time of compilation†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
CAT / XAT / GMAT and other management tests	IIMs / others	MBA / PGDM	CAT: Nov†
CUET-PG / university entrance	NTA / universities	MCom, MA / MSc Economics	Once a year†
CA Final / CS Professional / CMA Final	ICAI / ICSI / ICMAI	Qualified professional	Per institute calendar†
CFA Levels I-III	CFA Institute	Investment careers	Multiple windows†
UGC-NET (Commerce / Economics)	NTA	Lectureship and research	Twice a year†

5. Scholarships

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream (Commerce counts as its own stream); family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†

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Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†
ICAI / ICSI / ICMAI and corporate scholarships	Institutes and foundations	Merit and need based	Varies	Check each institute†

Note: INSPIRE-SHE is for natural and basic sciences, so Commerce students are generally not eligible for it.†

6. Courses and colleges

Course	Duration	Entry	Note
BCom (General / Hons / Professional / Accounting and Taxation / International Finance)	3-4 yr	Merit in Karnataka; CUET-UG for central universities	Common base for CA / CS / CMA preparation
BBA / BMS	3-4 yr	SET, NPAT, college tests, merit, CUET	Management foundation; MBA later
IPM (Integrated BBA + MBA)	5 yr	IPMAT (Indore, Rohtak) and similar	Direct route to IIM campuses
BA / BSc Economics (Hons)	3-4 yr	CUET-UG or college tests; Maths often needed	Policy, banking, research
BA LLB / BBA LLB	5 yr	CLAT and other law entrances	See section 8
BSc Statistics / Actuarial Science	3 yr	University merit or CUET; ACET for IAI route	Maths required in Class 12
CA / CS / CMA (with BCom)	4-5 yr (varies)	Foundation / CSEET exams as above	Professional licence
ACCA / CFA	Self-paced (3-4 yr+)	Direct entry rules†	Global credentials

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): Christ University, St Joseph's, Mount Carmel, Jain University, Bangalore University / BCU affiliated colleges, Shri Ram College of Commerce (DU), IIM Indore and Rohtak (IPM), NMIMS, Symbiosis, NLSIU Bengaluru (Law).†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study
Accounting and audit	Chartered accountant, auditor, tax consultant, forensic accountant, financial controller	CA Final, DISA, MBA, CFA
Corporate governance	Company secretary, compliance officer, corporate lawyer	CS Professional, LLB / LLM, MBA
Cost and management	Cost accountant, FP&A, strategy and operations roles	CMA Final, MBA
Finance and banking	Investment banker, equity analyst, banker, insurance professional, fintech roles	MBA Finance, CFA, FRM
Management and entrepreneurship	Business manager, consultant, marketer, start-up founder	MBA / PGDM, executive programmes
Economics and policy	Economist, researcher, policy analyst, civil servant	MA / MSc Economics, PhD, UPSC
Law and compliance	Corporate, tax and IP lawyer	LLM, judicial services
Actuarial and analytics	Actuary, risk analyst, data analyst in finance	IAI actuarial exams, MSc Statistics†

8. Related umbrellas this stream connects to

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- Law: CLAT is open to Commerce students; BBA LLB / BA LLB, corporate and tax law combine both.
- Management: IPM, BBA / BMS, then MBA; entrepreneurship and family business.
- Humanities and Economics: BA Economics, public policy, civil services (UPSC accepts any graduate).
- Technology / Data: fintech, analytics, accounting software; Commerce with Maths or Informatics Practices opens BCA / BSc Data Science.†
- Design: B.Des through UCEED and NID DAT accept students from any stream; marketing and brand design overlap with Commerce.†
- Defence: NDA Army wing accepts any stream; Air Force and Navy need Physics and Maths.†

ONE-PAGE GIST: Commerce

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-8	Build Maths and English; try IOQM from Class 8; Class 8: NMMS scholarship test
Class 9-10	Take Standard Maths if unsure; learn basic accounts and economics
After Class 10	Choose Commerce (+ Maths for Economics Hons, IPM, Actuarial); PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards; register for CA / CS / CMA Foundation; apply to CUET, IPMAT, CLAT, SET / NPAT
After Class 12	BCom / BBA / IPM / BA Economics / BA LLB; CA, CS, CMA alongside; ACCA / CFA
Postgraduate	MBA (CAT), MCom / MA Economics, LLM, CFA, CA Final

Exam	When	Pattern	Marking
CA Foundation	Jan, May/Jun, Sep	4 papers x 100; Papers 1-2 subjective, 3-4 objective	0.25 negative in objective
CSEET (ICSI)	Feb, Jun, Oct†	Four 100-mark papers (revised)†	Check notification
CMA Foundation	June and December	4 papers, MCQ, OMR	40% each, 50% total
IPMAT	May (Indore 4 May 2026)	2 hr: Quant MCQ + Quant SA + Verbal	+4 / -1 MCQ
CLAT	December (2027 expected 6 Dec 2026)	120 MCQs, 2 hr	+1 / -0.25
CUET-UG	May-June†	50 MCQs per subject, 60 min	+5 / -1

Key rules: CA / CS / CMA Foundation open after Class 12 (register early); BCom in Karnataka is mostly merit-based on 2nd PUC marks; Maths in Class 12 keeps IPM, Economics Hons and Actuarial open.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8, 12,000/yr), CSSS (12,000/yr UG), post-matric schemes via NSP / SSP.†

Careers: chartered accountant, company secretary, cost accountant, auditor, banker, analyst, manager, economist, corporate lawyer, actuary, entrepreneur.

Want a personalised roadmap or counselling? Contact LessonPlan, Yelahanka, Bangalore.

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